



## GREY BANNER ALERT



# SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

|                             |                               |                                 |            |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------|------------|
| <b>Date of Incident</b>     | 23 <sup>rd</sup> January 2026 | <b>Time of Incident</b>         | 2:30 PM    |
| <b>Directorate / Region</b> | Finance & Commercial Services | <b>Main Roads or Contractor</b> | Main Roads |
| <b>isafe Event Type</b>     | Injury – LTI                  | <b>isafe Incident Number</b>    | INC-0006   |
| <b>Actual Consequence</b>   | Moderate                      | <b>Potential Consequence</b>    | Moderate   |

|                                   |                                                    |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Incident Short Description</b> | Worker drops keyboard on to toe, resulting in LTI. |
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### Executive Summary

Worker was standing at their desk and was removing the laptop keyboard from the screen, when the keyboard portion, weighing approximately 900g, fell out of the worker's hand from the standing position, with the corner of the keyboard falling directly onto their left big toe.

The worker cried out, and then ended up sitting on the floor, visibly in a lot of pain.

Within 10 minutes of the incident the worker had taken Panadol and Nurofen and applied ice to the toe. This offered no relief and it was decided to transport them to Royal Perth Hospital (RPH) for medical attention.

X-Ray confirmed a flake fracture to left big toe. WorkSafe were notified of the incident.

### Incident Photos



***Image of the style of laptop and keyboard used by the worker***

## Contributing Factors

### Absent or Failed Defences

- Existing controls referenced in the risk register (manual handling training/procedures/ergonomics/housekeeping) are not specific to small IT equipment and do not explicitly address detaching components while unsupported (e.g., expectation to do so on a stable surface).

### Individual or Team Actions

- The incident was contributed to by a failure to assess the risk at the time of the task, including the worker's standing position while detaching/moving the laptop.

### Task or Environmental Conditions

- There was a lack of adequate instruction/guidance for workers using detachable-style IT equipment (e.g., safe method for detaching components).
- The Surface Book release button can stick, requiring multiple presses, which may increase the likelihood of an uncontrolled release/drop if the device is not fully supported.

### Organisational Factors

- Lack of communication to workers on known IT equipment issues.
- Directorate risk registers does not mention this kind of risk.

## Corrective Actions

- Advice to be given to users with a laptop of this style to be aware of the release feature and to carry out this action while both parts of the laptop are supported.
- Create a laptop "cheat sheet" to be made available for the various types and styles of laptops that there are across the business.
- Broken parts of the wheelchair to be ordered and tyres to be pumped up or inner tubes replaced.
- Include regular inspections on the equipment to ensure it is always ready to be used.
- All floors to check that ice packs are available and to share awareness of what these look like to assist with future requirements.
- Consider WFH patterns when assigning people into FAO roles to try avoiding trained personnel all being out of the office at the same time.
- Ensure first aid poster information is relevant to the specific floor and therefore the correct staff in safety based roles.
- Ownership sign / sticker to be added to the wheelchair and a log sheet to be placed in the first aid room that needs to be completed when staff take and return the wheelchair.
- Create "Injured Worker Checklist" to assist managers or FAOs to assist them with understanding the necessary steps have been taken or are in the process of being completed.
- Update Directorate Risk Register to include new hazard and risk mitigation controls.

## Additional Issues / Learnings

- The injured worker was wearing open-toe footwear, which may have increased injury severity once the drop occurred; however, available evidence indicates footwear was not a primary cause of the event.
- The task was undertaken as part of preparation for ad-hoc WFH arrangements (packing up and testing equipment). This highlights a need for consistent, practical guidance for safely packing

up/transporting IT equipment and for ensuring related workplace checks and user information are completed before commencing new work arrangements.

**Distribution of Notice**

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations